

Yes. We can now hold Incident 05 exactly where it is and expand **Incident 06 as the full recovery operation.**

This is the largest incident because everything built from the Prologue onward finally becomes operational here. The learner is no longer primarily being taught a new security mechanism. They are being asked to **use the capabilities they have earned.**

Incident 06 — Recovery Operation

1. Where we are coming from

Incident 05 ends with:

PQ-004

FINANCIAL LOSS

R1 000

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

FINANCIAL LEAD

.... 7394

A7

COMPROMISED / RETIRED

HQ IDENTITY

VERIFIABLE ✓

RED TEAM IDENTITY

VERIFIABLE ✓

HQ SIGNATURE SYSTEM

ACTIVE ✓

SESSION KEY S1

ACTIVE ✓

HQ ↔ RED TEAM

TRUSTED OPERATIONAL SESSION ✓

ACTOR

UNKNOWN

R1 000

NOT RECOVERED

For the first time, Phantom Q now has enough trusted infrastructure to act.

The question changes from:

How do we communicate securely?

to:

Now that we can trust our commands, how do we investigate the lead, operate within authority, find the diverted funds, recover them and restore Phantom Q?

2. What Incident 06 is actually about

Incident 06 combines three related but distinct problems.

1. CYBER RECOVERY

What infrastructure/path was abused?

How do we contain it?

How do we restore trust?

2. FINANCIAL RECOVERY

Where did the R1 000 go?

Can we stop further movement?

Can authorised Phantom Q controls return it?

3. ATTRIBUTION

Who actually operated the infrastructure?

The first two can be substantially resolved in Incident 06.

The third deliberately remains unresolved.

That gives us:

CYBER PATH	CONTAINED ✓
R1 000	RECOVERED ✓
PHANTOM Q	RESTORED ✓
ACTOR IDENTITY	UNKNOWN

This is why the title of the final Act is:

WE WON THE INCIDENT, NOT THE WAR

3. The most important operational rule

Incident 06 must **not** become:

```
Find hacker
↓
Hack hacker
↓
Find bank account
↓
Hack money back
```

That would break the technical logic we built.

The correct structure is:

```
VERIFY TRUSTED MISSION ORDER
↓
OPEN PRESERVED EVIDENCE
↓
TRACE NETWORK LEAD
↓
DISCOVER RELAY
↓
FOLLOW NEXT CONNECTION
↓
CORRELATE EVIDENCE
↓
VALIDATE TARGET
↓
INSPECT ATTACK SURFACE
↓
REQUEST AUTHORISATION
↓
VERIFY SIGNED AUTHORISATION
↓
AUTHORISED CONTROLLED ACCESS
↓
SEARCH / COLLECT ARTEFACTS
↓
PRESERVE + SIGN EVIDENCE
↓
CORRELATE CYBER + FINANCIAL TRAILS
↓
LOCATE R1 000
↓
CONTAIN FUNDS
↓
VERIFY SIGNED RECOVERY APPROVAL
↓
RETURN R1 000
↓
```

REMEDiate COMPROMISED PATH

↓

RESTORE

↓

VERIFY

↓

REPORT

↓

ACTOR STILL UNKNOWN

That is the full operational backbone.

4. How Incident 05 remains alive inside Incident 06

This is critical.

We do **not** teach asymmetric security all over again.

We use it.

There are five important asymmetric trust points.

1. Initial mission order

HQ PRIVATE KEY

↓

SIGNS RECOVERY ORDER

RED TEAM

↓

HQ PUBLIC KEY

↓

VERIFY

2. Normal mission traffic

After the order is trusted:

SESSION KEY S1

↓

ROUTINE HQ ↔ RED TEAM COMMUNICATION

3. Offensive action

Before any controlled attack:

```
HQ
SIGNS TARGET-SPECIFIC AUTHORISATION
↓
RED TEAM
VERIFIES
↓
ONLY THEN
ENGAGE
```

4. Evidence

Red Team later signs the evidence package:

```
RT PRIVATE KEY
↓
SIGN EVIDENCE

HQ
↓
RT PUBLIC KEY
↓
VERIFY
```

5. Financial recovery

Before the R1 000 is returned:

```
HQ
↓
SIGNED RECOVERY APPROVAL
↓
TRAINING PAYMENT SYSTEM
↓
VERIFY AUTHORITY
↓
RETURN FUNDS
```

So Incident 06 demonstrates exactly why Incident 05 mattered.

5. Incident 06 structure

We now have six Acts:

Act	Scenes	Purpose
I — The Hunt Begins	1–4	Mission → evidence → trace → relay
II — Follow the Ghost	5–9	Next connection → timeline → correlation → services
III — Permission to Engage	10–14	Target case → request → authority → verify → weakness
IV — Inside the Infrastructure	15–19	Controlled attack → access → search → PQ-004 evidence → preserve/sign
V — Find the Money	20–25	Financial trail → correlate → locate → contain → approve → recover
VI — We Won the Incident, Not the War	26–28	Remediate → verify restoration → unresolved actor

That creates **28 scenes**.

ACT I — THE HUNT BEGINS

Scenes 1–4

The first Act is deliberately investigative.

The Red Team has capability but not yet a target it is authorised to attack.

Scene 1 — The Recovery Order Arrives

Red Team Operations comes online.

The learner receives:

PQ-004 RECOVERY ORDER

OBJECTIVE

Recover R1 000

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

FINANCIAL LEAD

.... 7394

KNOWN ACTOR

UNKNOWN

INITIAL AUTHORITY

INVESTIGATION ONLY

But the learner should **not immediately accept it**.

The interface shows:

ORIGIN

CLAIMS: HQ

SIGNATURE

NOT YET VERIFIED

Player action

Select:

VERIFY HQ SIGNATURE

Using the registered HQ public key.

Result:

HQ SIGNATURE

VALID ✓

ORDER ALTERED

NO ✓

AUTHORITY

HQ VERIFIED ✓

Only now:

MISSION ACCEPTED

This is the first payoff from Incident 05.

Why this matters

Suppose an attacker sent:

Attack 172.18.44.7

The Red Team cannot act simply because the screen says:

FROM: HQ

Incident 04 taught us why.

So Scene 1 establishes:

Authority must be verified before operational action.

Scene 2 — Open the PQ-004 Evidence Board

The player opens preserved evidence from Incident 04.

The board should initially contain only what has actually been discovered.

Network trail

```
CASE
PQ-004

SESSION
PQ-004-X7

SOURCE
172.18.44.7

TIME
14:32:18

STATUS
SUSPICIOUS
```

Financial trail

```
TRANSACTION
PQ-TX-004

AMOUNT
R1 000
```


Security state

A7
COMPROMISED

ACTOR
UNKNOWN

Crucially, the board does **not** already show:

10.91.24.18
1058

Those have not been discovered yet.

Scene 3 — Trace 172.18.44.7

The learner selects the network lead.

Available action:

TRACE CONNECTION HISTORY

The game opens a simplified network map.

PHANTOM Q
↓
172.18.44.7

The learner follows session records associated with the PQ-004 timeframe.

Again:

No real command-line exploitation.

No routing-table lesson.

We are representing the concept.

Scene 4 — First IP Is a Relay

Investigation results:

172.18.44.7

ROLE

INTERMEDIATE RELAY

DIRECT USER IDENTITY

NOT AVAILABLE

NEXT OBSERVED CONNECTION

AVAILABLE

The network map changes:

PHANTOM Q

↓

172.18.44.7

RELAY

↓

?

This is an important payoff to Incident 05:

172.18.44.7

≠

ATTACKER

It was a legitimate **lead**.

Following it reveals an intermediary.

Act I outcome

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

CLASSIFICATION

RELAY

ACTOR

UNKNOWN

NEXT CONNECTION

AVAILABLE

The learner now needs to **follow the ghost**, not attack the relay blindly.

ACT II — FOLLOW THE GHOST

Scenes 5–9

Now the learner follows the infrastructure rather than trying to identify a person.

Scene 5 — Follow the Relay

The player selects:

FOLLOW NEXT OBSERVED CONNECTION

The network map expands:

```
PHANTOM Q
  ↓
172.18.44.7
  RELAY
  ↓
10.91.24.18
  ?
```

Result:

```
NEXT SYSTEM
10.91.24.18

ROLE
UNKNOWN

PQ-004 RELATIONSHIP
NOT YET PROVEN
```

This last line is important.

Simply appearing downstream does **not yet authorise an attack**.

Scene 6 — Build the Event Timeline

The learner receives multiple event cards.

Relevant records:

```
14:32:16
10.91.24.18
```

Connection activity

14:32:17

172.18.44.7

Relay activity

14:32:18

PQ-004

Replacement event

The player orders them.

Correct:

14:32:16

10.91.24.18

↓

14:32:17

172.18.44.7 RELAY

↓

14:32:18

PQ-004 REPLACEMENT

This is the Act I approximation of **log/event correlation**.

Failure behaviour

If the learner orders:

PQ-004

↓

relay

↓

candidate connection

the system should say:

TIMELINE CONFLICT

The candidate connection occurs
before the relay/PQ-004 activity.

Again, evidence drives correction.

Scene 7 — Compare Session Evidence

Now the learner compares:

```
TIME
DIRECTION
SESSION RELATION
NETWORK PATH
```

For example:

```
10.91.24.18
Time relationship      MATCH
Connection direction  MATCH
Relay relationship    MATCH
PQ-004 timing         MATCH
```

Result:

STRONG CORRELATION

But:

```
HUMAN ACTOR
UNKNOWN
```

Correct conclusion:

```
10.91.24.18
STRONGLY ASSOCIATED WITH PQ-004 INFRASTRUCTURE
```

Not:

This is the hacker's computer.

Scene 8 — Inspect the Candidate System

The learner now has enough evidence to perform **non-destructive attack-surface inspection**.

The fictional system exposes simplified service groups:

```
10.91.24.18

SERVICES

WEB
```

ACTIVE

REMOTE MANAGEMENT

ACTIVE

DATA SERVICE

ACTIVE

We do not show real ports/exploit strings unless we later deliberately add them in advanced releases.

The current question:

Which service has evidence related to PQ-004?

Scene 9 — Find the Relevant Service

The learner inspects each.

Web

PQ-004 MATCHES

0

Relevant session

None

Data

PQ-004 MATCHES

0

Relevant session

None

Remote Management

PQ-004 ACTIVITY

FOUND ✓

TIME

14:32 ✓

SESSION RELATION

MATCH ✓

Result:

REMOTE MANAGEMENT — RELEVANT SERVICE

This gives us a technically grounded target surface.

But the learner still does **not** have permission to attack it.

That is the point.

ACT III — PERMISSION TO ENGAGE

Scenes 10–14

This Act teaches one of the most important professional security principles:

Evidence that a system is relevant does not automatically give you authority to attack it.

Scene 10 — Build the Target Case

The learner must assemble:

TARGET

10.91.24.18

NETWORK PATH

172.18.44.7 → 10.91.24.18

PQ-004 CORRELATION

STRONG

TIME

14:32

RELEVANT SERVICE

Remote Management

ACTOR IDENTITY

UNKNOWN

The learner cannot simply type:

TARGET = ATTACKER

Correct classification:

TARGET SYSTEM
EVIDENCE-LINKED INFRASTRUCTURE

Once all evidence is attached:

TARGET CASE VALIDATED

Scene 11 — Request Controlled Access

Now Red Team prepares an offensive request.

OFFENSIVE ACTION REQUEST

CASE
PQ-004

TARGET
10.91.24.18

SCOPE
Remote Management

REASON
Evidence-linked PQ-004 investigation

PROPOSED ACTION
Controlled Access

ACTOR
Unknown

The request travels to HQ over:

SESSION S1

This is a routine operational message, so S1 is appropriate.

Result:

REQUEST SENT ✓
AUTHORITY PENDING

No attack yet.

Scene 12 — HQ Approves the Attack

HQ reviews the target-specific evidence.

Then HQ issues:

PQ-004 OFFENSIVE AUTHORISATION

TARGET

10.91.24.18

SCOPE

Remote Management

PERMITTED ACTION

Controlled access / evidence search

OTHER SERVICES

OUT OF SCOPE

HQ signs the authorisation using:

HQ PRIVATE KEY

Red Team receives it.

But initially:

SIGNATURE

NOT VERIFIED

This is deliberate.

Scene 13 — Verify Before You Engage

The learner must use:

HQ PUBLIC KEY

Result:

SIGNATURE

VALID ✓

TARGET

10.91.24.18 ✓

SCOPE

Remote Management ✓

MESSAGE ALTERED

NO ✓

Only now does the button change from:

ENGAGE

LOCKED

to:

ENGAGE

This is the major operational use of asymmetric authenticity.

Scene 14 — Find the Weak Point

Now that target inspection is authorised, the learner can examine the Remote Management surface more closely.

Simplified findings:

REMOTE MANAGEMENT

CURRENT INTERFACE

Secured ✓

LEGACY ACCESS

Exposed ⚠

RECOVERY CONSOLE

Restricted

The learner needs to choose the evidence-supported route.

Correct:

LEGACY ACCESS — EXPOSED

Not because we teach a real exploit.

The lesson is:

SECURED CURRENT INTERFACE

not useful

RESTRICTED RECOVERY CONSOLE

not authorised/currently inaccessible

EXPOSED LEGACY ACCESS

evidence-linked weak point

This completes the attack-planning Act.

ACT IV — INSIDE THE INFRASTRUCTURE

Scenes 15–19

Now we finally permit offensive action.

This should feel significant because the learner had to earn both **evidence** and **authority**.

Scene 15 — Controlled Access

Player selects:

INITIATE CONTROLLED ACCESS

The game simulates authorised exploitation of the fictional legacy interface.

No real exploit syntax is necessary.

Visual sequence:

TARGET

10.91.24.18

SERVICE

Remote Management

ROUTE

Legacy Access

AUTHORITY

Verified ✓

↓

CONTROLLED ACCESS

↓

SESSION ESTABLISHED ✓

Scope remains visible:

PERMITTED

Remote Management

NOT PERMITTED

Other unrelated services

The player is now **inside authorised scope**.

Scene 16 — Search the System

The learner sees simplified areas:

FILES

SESSIONS

CONNECTION HISTORY

TRANSFER RECORDS

Known investigation clues remain pinned:

PQ-004

14:32

7394

The learner can search/filter using these clues.

This is the Release 1 representation of host investigation / digital forensics.

Poor search

If they search random irrelevant material:

MATCHES

0

The system does not punish them.

The known clue panel remains visible.

This teaches focused investigation.

Scene 17 — Find the PQ-004 Artefact

Using:

PQ-004

the learner finds a transfer artefact.

It shows:

Original record

ORIGINAL INSTRUCTION

Amount

R100

Destination

4821

Replacement record

REPLACEMENT INSTRUCTION

Amount

R1 000

Destination

7394

Status:

FORWARDED

This is extremely important.

For the first time the infrastructure itself contains evidence explaining what happened between Alice and Bob.

But the actor is still not identified.

Scene 18 — Discover Where the Money Went Next

The learner opens the transfer-forwarding record.

PQ-004

BOB

↓

7394

↓

FORWARDED

↓

.... 1058

New evidence:

FINANCIAL LEAD UPDATED

7394

↓

1058

This is the key bridge between **cyber investigation** and **financial recovery**.

Note that the learner has not recovered anything yet.

They merely know where to look next.

Scene 19 — Preserve and Sign the Evidence

Before changing or remediating anything:

PRESERVE EVIDENCE

The learner selects:

SESSION RECORD

CONNECTION HISTORY

TRANSFER RECORD

TIMESTAMPS

PQ-004 ARTEFACT

7394 → 1058 FORWARDING RECORD

The system produces:

PQ-004 EVIDENCE PACKAGE

Now Red Team signs it using:

RT PRIVATE KEY

Flow:

EVIDENCE PACKAGE

+

RT PRIVATE KEY

↓

SIGN

↓

SIGNED EVIDENCE PACKAGE

HQ receives it and verifies using:

RT PUBLIC KEY

Result:

ORIGIN

RED TEAM UNIT 01 ✓

ALTERED

NO ✓

EVIDENCE PACKAGE

ACCEPTED ✓

Another direct Incident 05 payoff.

Why preservation comes before remediation

The learner should understand:

INVESTIGATE

↓

PRESERVE

↓

THEN REMEDIATE

not:

FIND BAD THING

↓

DELETE EVERYTHING

Because destroying artefacts may damage the investigation and recovery case.

ACT V — FIND THE MONEY

Scenes 20–25

Now the mission changes from primarily cyber investigation into **cyber-financial correlation**.

Scene 20 — Reopen the Financial Trail

The original financial trail was:

R1 000

↓

7394

New cyber evidence adds:

7394

↓

1058

The evidence board now shows:

KNOWN FINANCIAL TRAIL

BOB

↓

7394

↓

1058

Player selects:

FOLLOW FUNDS

Scene 21 — Correlate the Two Trails

Now the player places cyber and financial evidence side-by-side.

Cyber evidence

PQ-004 artefact

7394 → 1058

Financial evidence

PQ-004 transaction history

7394 → 1058

The learner runs:

CORRELATE

Result:

ACCOUNT

1058

CYBER RECORD

MATCH ✓

FINANCIAL RECORD

MATCH ✓

PQ-004 RELATION

CONFIRMED ✓

This is important.

We do not recover funds simply because a cyber artefact mentioned an account.

We confirm it against an independent financial record.

Scene 22 — Locate the R1 000

The fictional Phantom Q Training Payment Network shows:

ACCOUNT

.... 1058

PQ-004 RELATED FUNDS
R1 000

STATUS
HELD

OUTBOUND MOVEMENT
AVAILABLE

The learner has now **located** the funds.

But:

RECOVERY STATUS
NOT RECOVERED

Location is not recovery.

Scene 23 — Stop It Moving

The player should not immediately click **Return Funds**.

The first operational action is:

REQUEST HOLD

The payment system checks:

PQ-004 CASE LINK	✓
EVIDENCE PACKAGE	✓
ACCOUNT CORRELATION	✓
RECOVERY AUTHORITY	Pending

It can still temporarily contain movement according to Phantom Q's fictional training controls.

Result:

ACCOUNT 1058

OUTBOUND MOVEMENT
SUSPENDED ✓

PQ-004 R1 000
CONTAINED ✓

This teaches:

Containment before recovery.

The money is no longer moving.

But it is still not returned.

Scene 24 — Request Recovery

Red Team sends HQ:

```
PQ-004 RECOVERY REQUEST
```

```
FUNDS LOCATED
```

```
R1 000
```

```
CURRENT LOCATION
```

```
.... 1058
```

```
FINANCIAL LINK
```

```
CONFIRMED
```

```
CYBER LINK
```

```
CONFIRMED
```

```
FUNDS
```

```
CONTAINED
```

```
EVIDENCE
```

```
PRESERVED
```

Routine report travels over S1.

HQ reviews and creates a **high-value authorisation**:

```
PQ-004 FINANCIAL RECOVERY APPROVAL
```

```
AMOUNT
```

```
R1 000
```

```
SOURCE
```

```
.... 1058
```

```
DESTINATION
```

```
PQ Secure Recovery
```

CASE

HQ signs it.

The training payment system verifies:

HQ SIGNATURE	✓
CASE	✓
AMOUNT	✓
RECOVERY AUTHORITY	✓

Only then is recovery enabled.

Scene 25 — Recover the R1 000

The learner initiates:

EXECUTE RECOVERY

Flow:

```
.... 1058
    |
    | R1 000
    ▼
PQ SECURE RECOVERY
```

Result:

```
PQ-004

R1 000
RECOVERED ✓
```

This is the payoff that started all the way back in Incident 04.

We should give this moment some weight.

But **do not finish the incident here.**

Getting the money back does not mean Phantom Q is safe.

ACT VI — WE WON THE INCIDENT, NOT THE WAR

Scenes 26–28

Now we move from recovery into restoration.

Scene 26 — Remove the Compromised Path

The learner returns to the cyber side.

Current problems include:

```
A7 compromised
PQ-004 suspicious session
Legacy access exposure
Malicious/abused infrastructure path
```

Now remediation can occur because evidence has already been preserved.

Actions:

```
A7
KEEP RETIRED ✓

PQ-004 SUSPICIOUS SESSION
CLOSE ✓

COMPROMISED / ABUSED ROUTE
BLOCK ✓

LEGACY ACCESS
CLOSE / REMOVE ✓

RELATED ACCESS
REVIEW ✓
```

Result:

```
COMPROMISED PATH
CONTAINED / REMEDIATED ✓
```

Again:

This does not prove who the actor was.

Scene 27 — Verify Phantom Q Is Safe Again

Restoration must be tested.

Not simply assumed.

The learner performs an end-to-end trust test.

HQ command

HQ creates a test command.

HQ signs it.

Red Team verifies.

Session

The command travels over:

S1

Red Team recovers it.

Red Team responds.

Security checks

HQ IDENTITY

VERIFIED ✓

RED TEAM IDENTITY

VERIFIED ✓

SESSION S1

PASS ✓

MESSAGE INTEGRITY

PASS ✓

UNAUTHORISED A7 USE

NONE ACTIVE ✓

COMPROMISED PATH

BLOCKED ✓

Result:

SERVICE RESTORED

This is a much stronger ending than:

“We deleted the attacker.”

Scene 28 — Incident 06 End State

The final incident board should be comprehensive.

PQ-004 RECOVERY OPERATION

FINANCIAL LOSS

R1 000

R1 000

RECOVERED ✓

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

172.18.44.7 ROLE

INTERMEDIATE RELAY ✓

RELATED SYSTEM

10.91.24.18 ✓

PQ-004 INFRASTRUCTURE

TRACED ✓

REMOTE MANAGEMENT PATH

INVESTIGATED ✓

PQ-004 ARTEFACTS

FOUND ✓

FORWARDING RECORD

7394 → 1058 ✓

FUNDS

LOCATED ✓

FUNDS

CONTAINED ✓

RECOVERY APPROVAL

VERIFIED ✓

EVIDENCE

PRESERVED ✓

RED TEAM EVIDENCE

SIGNED ✓

A7

RETIRED ✓

SUSPICIOUS SESSION

CLOSED ✓

COMPROMISED PATH

CONTAINED ✓

SESSION S1

TRUSTED ✓

PHANTOM Q SERVICES

RESTORED ✓

ACTOR IDENTITY

UNKNOWN

The final visual should not suddenly reveal Eve or some hooded hacker.

At most:

PHANTOM

?

or an unresolved marker.

Then:

INCIDENT CLOSED

ACTOR UNRESOLVED

And the line:

We recovered the incident. We did not identify the adversary.

That leaves the wider Phantom campaign alive.

6. What the learner physically does across Incident 06

This incident should be the most action-heavy section so far.

The learner:

1. receives the HQ recovery order;
2. verifies the HQ signature;
3. accepts the operation;
4. opens PQ-004 evidence;
5. isolates 172.18.44.7;
6. traces the connection history;
7. discovers the relay;
8. follows the next connection;
9. discovers 10.91.24.18;
10. builds the event timeline;
11. correlates session/time/path evidence;
12. identifies the candidate infrastructure;
13. inspects exposed services;
14. identifies Remote Management as relevant;
15. builds the target case;
16. submits an offensive-authorisation request;
17. receives signed HQ approval;
18. verifies the signature;
19. inspects the authorised target surface;
20. identifies exposed legacy access;
21. initiates controlled access;
22. searches sessions/files/history/transfer records;
23. finds the PQ-004 artefact;
24. discovers 7394 → 1058;
25. preserves the evidence;
26. signs the evidence package;
27. sends it to HQ;
28. follows the financial trail;
29. correlates cyber and financial records;
30. locates R1 000 at 1058;
31. requests a hold;
32. contains further movement;
33. requests financial recovery;
34. verifies/uses the signed HQ recovery approval;
35. executes R1 000 recovery;
36. removes compromised access;
37. closes the suspicious session;
38. keeps A7 retired;
39. verifies S1;
40. runs restoration checks;

- 41. submits/signs the final operational report;
- 42. closes PQ-004 while leaving actor attribution unresolved.

That is a significant increase in player agency from the Prologue.

Which is exactly what progression should feel like.

7. The learner's information progression

We should be strict about what they know at each stage.

Start

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

FINANCIAL LEAD

7394

ACTOR

UNKNOWN

After Act I

172.18.44.7

IS A RELAY

NEXT CONNECTION

AVAILABLE

After early Act II

10.91.24.18

DISCOVERED

But not yet:

10.91.24.18 = attacker

After correlation

10.91.24.18

STRONGLY LINKED TO PQ-004

After service inspection

REMOTE MANAGEMENT

PQ-004 RELEVANT

After authorisation

WE ARE AUTHORISED

TO PERFORM CONTROLLED ACCESS

AGAINST THIS SPECIFIC TARGET/SCOPE

After infrastructure search

PQ-004 REPLACEMENT RECORD

FOUND

7394 → 1058

FOUND

After financial correlation

1058

CONFIRMED PQ-004 FINANCIAL DESTINATION

After containment

R1 000

LOCATED AND HELD

After recovery

R1 000
RECOVERED

Final

INFRASTRUCTURE
CONTAINED

PHANTOM Q
RESTORED

ACTOR
UNKNOWN

That is the correct knowledge curve.

8. Character roles during Incident 06

The learner / Red Team operator

This is the largest evolution.

They move from:

Prologue
New trainee

to:

Incident 06
Trusted operational security participant

They can now:

VERIFY AUTHORITY
TRACE EVIDENCE
CORRELATE
BUILD TARGET CASE
RESPECT SCOPE

PERFORM AUTHORISED CONTROLLED ATTACK
SEARCH ARTEFACTS
PRESERVE EVIDENCE
CORRELATE FINANCIAL + CYBER TRAILS
CONTAIN
RECOVER
REMEDiate
VERIFY RESTORATION

This is the payoff of the entire campaign.

HQ

HQ becomes a real operational authority.

HQ:

```
issues mission order
↓
signs it
↓
approves offensive scope
↓
signs offensive authorisation
↓
receives evidence
↓
verifies RT signature
↓
approves financial recovery
↓
signs recovery order
```

HQ is not just a narrator anymore.

Red Team

Red Team is now active rather than standby.

Its role:

HUNT
CORRELATE
REQUEST
ENGAGE
COLLECT
PRESERVE

They are authorised Phantom Q personnel.

Not criminals.

Alice

Alice does not need to be forced into every Incident 06 scene.

But her original PQ-004 instruction remains critical evidence:

R100 / 4821

She is still the historical **source-of-truth**.

Bob

Bob's transaction:

R1 000 → 7394

remains part of the financial trail.

Again, Bob is not blamed.

His behaviour in Incident 04 was based on a security architecture we later proved insufficient.

Eve

Eve remains authorised Security Support.

She may assist with:

- SOC monitoring;
- evidence review;
- operational system status;
- restoration verification.

But we must preserve:

EVE RESPONSIBLE
NOT ESTABLISHED

No visual suggestion of guilt.

The unknown actor

Still represented through:

A7 activity
↓
relay
↓
candidate infrastructure
↓
PQ-004 artefacts
↓
financial forwarding

We uncover the **operation**, not the **person**.

That distinction is fundamental.

9. How Headquarters should change throughout Incident 06

Incident 06 should feel physically bigger because the learner now has more clearance.

At the start:

SOC
ACTIVE

RED TEAM
ACTIVE

CENTRAL OPS
RESTRICTED INCIDENT MODE

Acts I–II

The learner moves mainly between:

SOC

↔

RED TEAM OPERATIONS

Network/evidence displays become active.

Act III

HQ Command becomes important.

Authorisation must visibly come from outside the Red Team itself.

The player cannot self-authorise.

Act IV

Red Team's target-operation interfaces become active.

Act V

The operation links:

RED TEAM

↔

SOC

↔

FINANCIAL / RECOVERY CONTROL

↔

HQ COMMAND

Act VI

The learner returns toward:

CENTRAL OPERATIONS

as normal service is restored.

That creates a satisfying spatial loop:

PROLOGUE

Central Operations — normal

INCIDENT 04

Central Operations — compromised consequence

INCIDENT 06

Central Operations — restored

10. The major gameplay mechanics

Incident 06 should combine everything we have built rather than feeling like another quiz.

Signature verification

Used at major authority gates.

Evidence board

Persistent multi-trail case board.

Simplified network tracing

Nodes and connection relationships.

Timeline reconstruction

Reuse of Incident 01 reasoning.

Correlation

TIME

+

SESSION

+

NETWORK PATH

+

SERVICE

Attack-surface inspection

Simplified service objects.

Scope/authorisation gate

No offensive action before approval.

Controlled offensive access

Simulated and fictional, without real exploitation syntax.

Artefact search

Use known evidence clues to filter information.

Evidence preservation/signing

Before remediation.

Cyber-financial correlation

Two independent evidence sources must agree.

Containment

Stop movement before attempting recovery.

Signed financial recovery approval

High-value action requires verifiable authority.

Restoration testing

The operation is not finished merely because money returned.

11. Failure logic

Incident 06 should probably have the strongest consequence system in Release 1.

Claim:

172.18.44.7 = attacker

Response:

ATTRIBUTION NOT SUPPORTED

The address identifies an intermediary
network point associated with the incident.

Human identity remains unknown.

Engage 172.18.44.7 immediately

TARGET VALIDATION FAILED

172.18.44.7 has been classified
as an intermediary relay.

Follow the evidence before engagement.

Engage 10.91.24.18 before correlation

INSUFFICIENT TARGET EVIDENCE

Relationship to PQ-004
has not yet been established.

Engage before HQ authority

OFFENSIVE ACTION BLOCKED

Valid target evidence
does not itself constitute authorisation.

This line is important.

Attack wrong service

For example, Web.

Result:

```
PQ-004 MATCHES
```

```
0
```

```
RELEVANT SESSION
```

```
NONE
```

```
TARGET CASE
```

```
NOT ADVANCED
```

The learner gets a dead end, not a “wrong” banner.

Exceed scope

If authorised for Remote Management but player attempts unrelated Data Service:

```
OUT OF SCOPE
```

```
Current authorisation:
```

```
10.91.24.18
```

```
Remote Management only
```

Blocked.

Random search inside system

```
MATCHES
```

```
0
```

Known clues remain pinned:

```
PQ-004
```

```
14:32
```

```
7394
```

Delete/remediate before evidence preservation

EVIDENCE INTEGRITY WARNING

Changing the system before preservation
may destroy information required
for investigation and recovery.

Operation pauses until preservation.

Follow 7394 straight to recovery without checking cyber evidence

FINANCIAL LINK
INCOMPLETE

Independent evidence does not yet confirm
the next destination.

Recover before containing funds

RECOVERY PRECONDITION FAILED

Funds remain capable of further movement.

Contain first.

Attempt recovery without HQ approval

FINANCIAL AUTHORITY
NOT VERIFIED

High-value recovery action
requires signed HQ approval.

Consider incident finished after getting R1 000 back

RECOVERY INCOMPLETE

Financial recovery achieved.

Cyber remediation and
restoration verification remain outstanding.

This is particularly important.

Claim actor identified from infrastructure

ATTRIBUTION NOT ESTABLISHED

Infrastructure relationship
does not prove human operator identity.

12. Real concepts underneath the gameplay

Player action	Real concept
Verify initial order	Command authentication
Reopen evidence	Incident-response continuity
Trace 172.18.44.7	Network investigation
Discover relay	Infrastructure $\neq$ actor
Follow next connection	Threat hunting
Build timeline	Event/log correlation
Compare sessions	Evidence correlation
Inspect services	Attack-surface assessment
Build target case	Target validation
Request authority	Rules of engagement/scope

Player action	Real concept
Verify HQ approval	Authorised offensive security
Controlled access	Ethical/authorised penetration activity
Search records	Simplified digital forensics
Find PQ-004 artefact	Host evidence
Preserve evidence	Forensic integrity
RT signs evidence	Evidence origin/integrity
Follow 7394 → 1058	Financial tracing
Correlate two trails	Independent evidence confirmation
Hold funds	Containment
Signed HQ recovery approval	High-value authority
Return R1 000	Financial recovery
Remove weak path	Remediation
Test S1/comms	Restoration verification
Actor remains unknown	Attribution discipline

13. What Incident 06 deliberately does NOT teach deeply

We stay disciplined about Release 1.

Do not turn this into an expert SOC/pentest course.

Leave for later Releases:

- CIDR/subnetting;
- routing protocols;
- NAT analysis;
- packet captures;

- real SIEM query languages;
- genuine shell exploit commands;
- CVE exploitation;
- persistence techniques;
- privilege escalation;
- lateral movement details;
- professional malware analysis;
- full disk forensics;
- complete chain-of-custody processes;
- bank/payment-network regulation;
- advanced attribution;
- real offensive tooling.

Release 1 teaches the **logic of the operation**.

Later Acts can deepen the tools.

14. Persistent evidence and capability created

Incident 06 should permanently update PQ-004.

PQ-004

```
|
|— Original Alice Instruction
|   R100 / 4821
|
|— Diverted Transaction
|   R1 000 / 7394
|
|— Network Lead
|   172.18.44.7
|
|— Relay Classification
|   172.18.44.7
|
|— Related Infrastructure
|   10.91.24.18
|
|— Relevant Service
|   Remote Management
|
|— PQ-004 Artefact
|
|— Financial Forwarding
|   7394 → 1058
|
```



```
|— Signed Evidence Package
|
|— Fund Containment Record
|
|— Signed Recovery Approval
|
|— Recovery Record
|   R1 000 recovered
|
|— Remediation Record
|
|— Restoration Verification
|
|— Attribution
|   UNKNOWN
```

This becomes historical mission evidence for later Acts.

15. Incident 06 success condition

Success requires much more than money recovery.

MISSION ORDER

HQ VERIFIED ✓

NETWORK LEAD

TRACED ✓

172.18.44.7

RELAY ✓

NEXT SYSTEM

10.91.24.18 ✓

PQ-004 CORRELATION

ESTABLISHED ✓

RELEVANT SERVICE

REMOTE MANAGEMENT ✓

TARGET CASE

VALIDATED ✓

HQ OFFENSIVE AUTHORISATION

VERIFIED ✓

CONTROLLED ACCESS

COMPLETE ✓

PQ-004 ARTEFACT

FOUND ✓

7394 → 1058

CONFIRMED ✓

EVIDENCE

PRESERVED ✓

RT EVIDENCE SIGNATURE

VERIFIED ✓

FUNDS

LOCATED ✓

FUNDS

CONTAINED ✓

HQ RECOVERY AUTHORITY

VERIFIED ✓

R1 000

RECOVERED ✓

A7

RETIRED ✓

COMPROMISED PATH

REMEDIATED ✓

SUSPICIOUS SESSION

CLOSED ✓

S1

VERIFIED ✓

PHANTOM Q SERVICES

RESTORED ✓

ACTOR

UNKNOWN ✓

And yes — “actor unknown” is part of the correct success state, not an incomplete mission.

16. The entire Incident 06 flow

INCIDENT 05 COMPLETE

↓

RED TEAM READY

↓

HQ RECOVERY ORDER ARRIVES

↓

VERIFY HQ SIGNATURE

↓

MISSION AUTHORISED

↓

OPEN PQ-004 EVIDENCE

↓

NETWORK LEAD

172.18.44.7

↓

TRACE

↓

172.18.44.7 = RELAY

↓

FOLLOW NEXT CONNECTION

↓

10.91.24.18

↓

BUILD TIMELINE

↓

CORRELATE TIME / SESSION / PATH

↓

PQ-004 RELATION STRONGLY SUPPORTED

↓

INSPECT SERVICES

↓

REMOTE MANAGEMENT

PQ-004 ACTIVITY FOUND

↓

BUILD TARGET CASE

↓

REQUEST CONTROLLED ACCESS

VIA S1

↓

HQ REVIEWS

↓

HQ SIGNS OFFENSIVE AUTHORISATION

↓

RED TEAM VERIFIES

↓

TARGET / SCOPE / AUTHORITY MATCH

↓

ENGAGE

↓

IDENTIFY EXPOSED LEGACY ACCESS

↓

CONTROLLED ACCESS ESTABLISHED

↓

SEARCH

VERIFY HQ ↔ RED TEAM TRUST

↓

VERIFY S1

↓

VERIFY INTEGRITY

↓

VERIFY SERVICE

↓

PHANTOM Q RESTORED

↓

SIGNED FINAL REPORT

↓

PQ-004 INCIDENT RECOVERED

↓

ACTOR IDENTITY

UNKNOWN

↓

WE WON THE INCIDENT

That gives us the full **Incident 06 design specification** and, importantly, closes the complete chain from the Prologue: the learner progresses from simply noticing that a file is wrong to participating in a trusted, authorised, evidence-driven recovery operation — while the Phantom itself remains unresolved for the wider campaign.